AdsDetective

BRAND GUIDELINES



Version 3 · November 2026 · For web, social and print

The idea

AdsDetective is a patient investigator for advertising. He studies the ads in a field, keeps one eye on the clue and the other on the next lead, and always comes back with something you can use.

The mark is a tall, friendly detective in a trench coat with a popped collar and a wide hat, holding a magnifying glass. His eyes peek out of the collar. He walks and looks around, so the brand always feels like it is on the case.

Personality

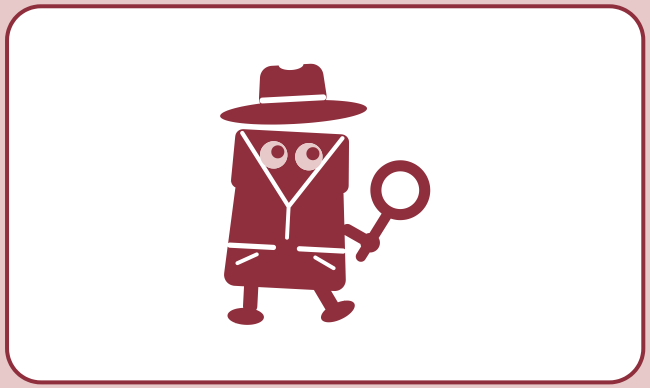
Curious · Calm · Honest about what he finds · A little playful

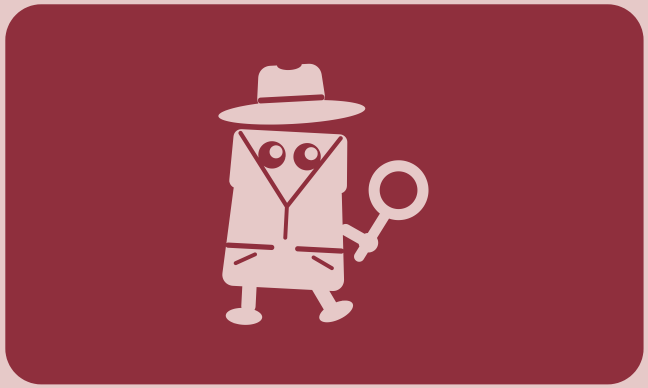
What it is not

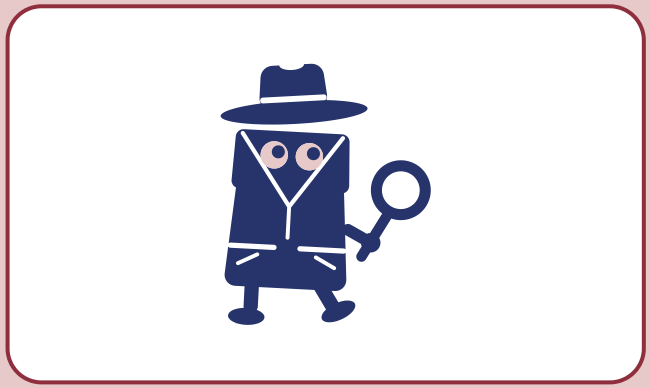
- No spy, no secret agent, no menace. He investigates in the open.
- No mouth. His eyes do all the talking.
- No gloss, no gradients. Flat colour, soft shapes.

Where the look comes from

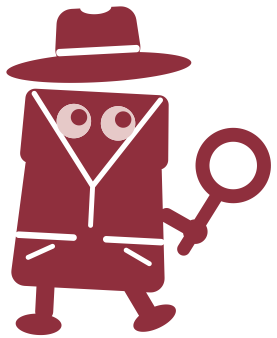
A palette taken from traditional Japanese colours, bubble-shaped lettering, and the walking mascot of the RemoteMatches site. The detective is a new original character with his own shape, hat and magnifying glass, inspired by the classic trench-coat sleuth.







Primary logo



Ads
Detective

Clear space

Keep a margin around the logo equal to twice the width of one of the detective's eyes. Nothing else enters that space.

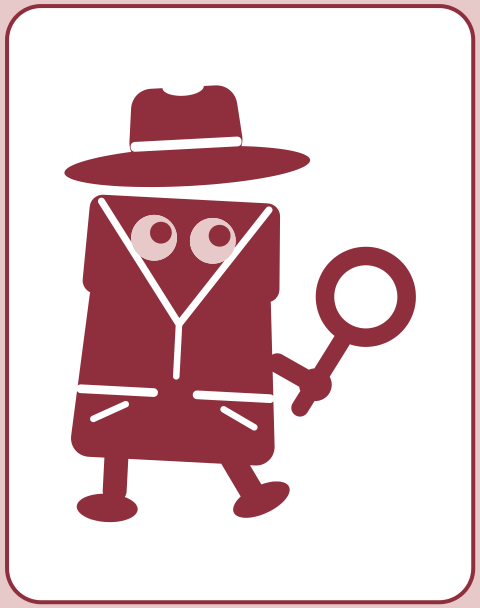
Smallest sizes

Symbol alone: 24 px wide on screen, 10 mm in print.
Horizontal lockup: 160 px wide on screen, 35 mm in print.
Below that, use the symbol only.

Which to use

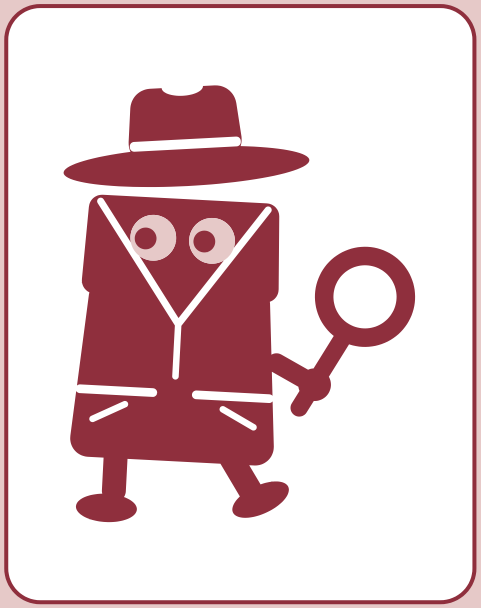
Horizontal lockup for headers and documents. Vertical lockup for posters and covers. Symbol for icons, avatars and stickers.

The detective and his poses



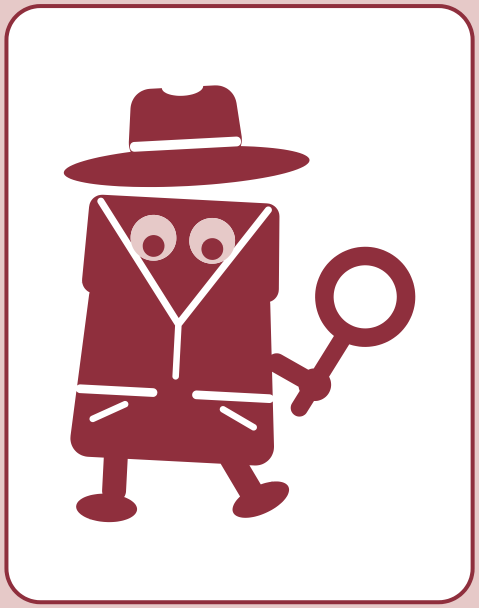
Looking

The default. Eyes up and to the right, scanning the horizon.



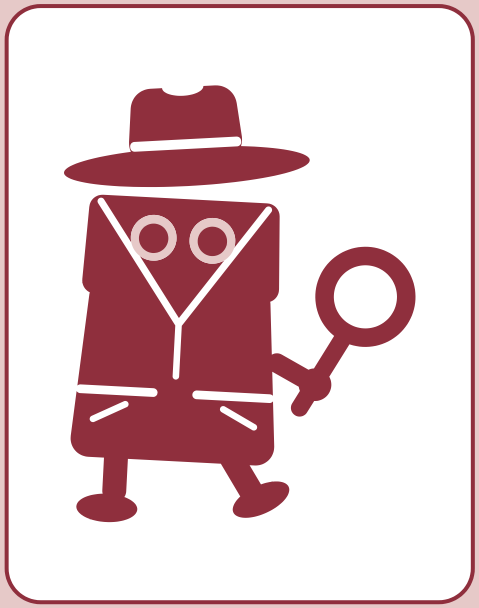
Scanning

Looks to the left. Use when moving on to the next lead.



Reading

Looks down at a file. Use for lists and reports.

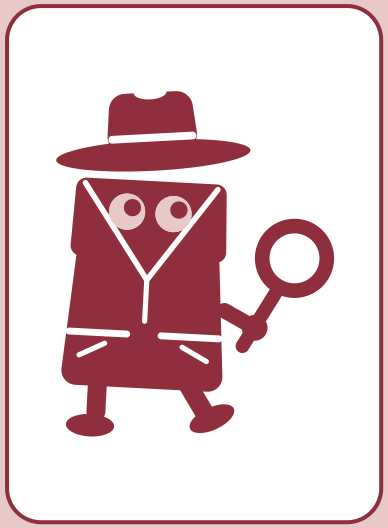


Found it

Eyes wide and centred. Use when there is a result.

Only the pupils move between poses. The shape stays the same. On the web he also walks: a gentle bounce with a three degree sway, and his eyes drift between these poses every few seconds. The animation stops for people who ask their device to reduce motion.

Logo family and colourways



Symbol

Ads Detective

Stacked wordmark



Horizontal lockup



Vertical lockup



Red on light



Blue on light



Cameo on red



Sticker on red

Misuse



Do not stretch or squash



Do not rotate



Do not add a mouth, shadow or outline



Do not use colours outside the palette

Also avoid: placing the red symbol on a red background without the light outline (use the sticker version), putting blue text or blue logo parts on a red background, and redrawing the detective or changing his hat, coat or magnifying glass.

Good pairings







Colour

Deep Pompeian Red
#8F2F3D
RGB 143, 47, 61
Core · 45%

Backgrounds, logo, headlines

Cameo Pink
#E6C9C8
RGB 230, 201, 200
Core · 35%

Pages, cards, text on red

Dark Tyrian Blue
#27346B
RGB 39, 52, 107
Accent · 12%

Buttons, details, shadows

Light Glaucous Blue
#AFBDCA
RGB 175, 189, 202
Support · 8%

Lines, tags, quiet panels



Pair	Contrast	Grade
Cameo on Red	5.13:1	AA
Red on Cameo	5.13:1	AA
Red on white	7.95:1	AAA
Blue on Cameo	7.57:1	AAA
Blue on Glaucous	6.12:1	AA
Glaucous on Red	4.15:1	Large text only
Blue on Red	1.48:1	Do not use

Colours come from the swatch book in the reference photo, tuned by eye for screens. The red is a slightly deeper version of the swatch Pompeian Red, so light text on it stays readable. Printed results will look slightly different; check a proof. Grades follow WCAG: AAA 7, AA 4.5, large text 3.

Typography

Display · logo and headlines

Bagel Fat One

AdsDetective

Follow the ads, áéíóú ãõ ç ñ

Slogan · capitals only

ANTON

EYES ON THE ADS. CASE FILE OPEN.

Text · everything else

Inter Tight

Regular 400 for text, semibold 600 for labels, bold 700 for small headings. Accents and Portuguese and Spanish characters all work.

Headline 54

Section 34

Body 18 / 1.55. Short lines, left aligned, never centred in long paragraphs.

Licences: Bagel Fat One, Anton and Inter Tight are all open fonts under the SIL Open Font License, free for commercial use. The logo letters are drawn as shapes, so the font does not need to be installed to use the logo files.

Applications

Ads Detective

Cases Reports New case

WHICH ADS ARE WORKING?

Sample page. Ask a question and the detective brings back the ads, the angles and the gaps.

Open a case



SAMPLE CASE FILE

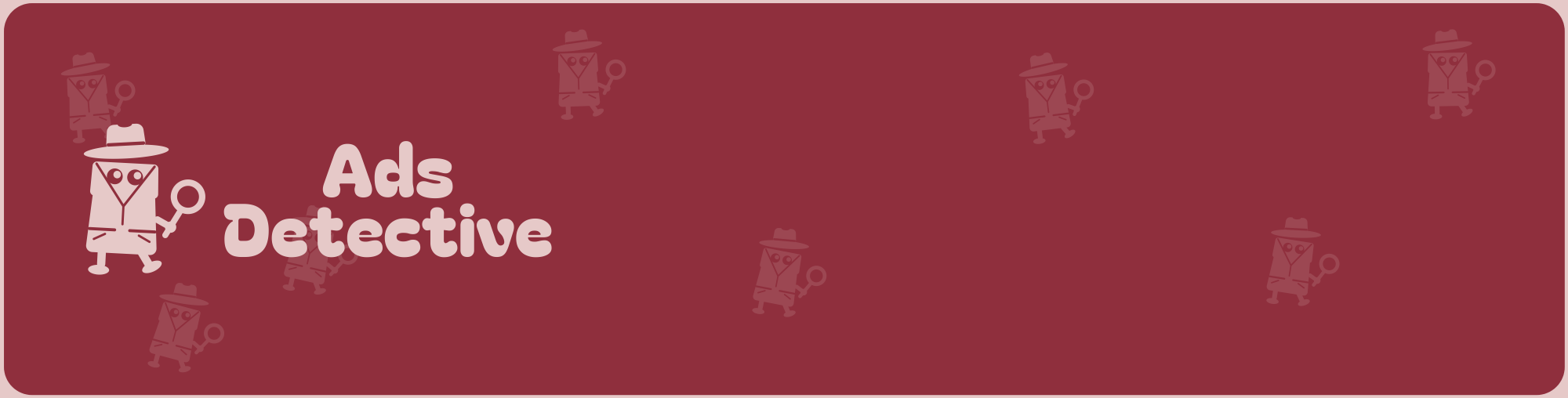
Case 014

Placeholder text for layout only. Advertiser, platform, days running, hook and angle go here.

Meta Video

Long runner

Banners, avatars and stickers





Round avatar



App icon



Sticker



Browser tab

Voice

How he sounds

Short, clear and straight. He tells you what he found, how sure he is, and what he could not see.

- Say what the data shows and what it does not.
- Prefer a plain word to a clever one.
- A little humour is fine. Never mock the reader.



Taglines

EYES ON THE ADS.

CASE FILE OPEN.

FIND WHAT WORKS.

ALWAYS ON THE CASE.

File guide

What is in the pack

- **svg/** Vector logos for every design and colourway, plus the animated detective.
- **png/** Transparent images, 1600 to 3000 px wide.
- **poses/** The four eye poses of the symbol, SVG and PNG.
- **icons/** Favicon, app icon, round avatar.

Naming

adsdetective_[design]_[colourway]
Designs: symbol, wordmark, wordmark-stacked, lockup-horizontal, lockup-vertical.
Colourways: red, blue, cameo, on-red.

Which colourway

Red or blue on light backgrounds. Cameo on red or other dark backgrounds. On-red is a complete image with its own background and a light outline, made for stickers and avatars.

Icons in the pack

